

VAN PATRICK

Heroes die, but their clones live on



MVP's short career ended while saving his friend Cloud 9.

Michael Van Patrick was the most gifted and well-rounded athlete in his hometown of Liberty, Kentucky. However, when word got out that his great-grandfather had been Dr. Abraham Erskine, the creator of the Super-Solider Serum, he was suspected of having superpowers, and all his records were taken away. In truth, Michael's father Brian had simply used Erskine's studies to train his son to perfection from birth.

THE INITIATIVE

After the Civil War (see pp.84-5)

Vance Astrovik (see MARVEL BOY) recruited Van Patrick to join the Fifty State Initiative (see pp. 118-9). As MVP, Van Patrick reported for training at Camp Hammond in Connecticut, under the command of GAUNTLET. Sadly, MVP was killed during his first combat exercise. After TRAUMA terrified ARMORY by morphing into a giant spider, she fired her Tactigon in panic. MVP rescued CLOUD 9 from a stray blast, but the next shot killed him.

COVER-UPS AND CLONES

Henry Peter GYRICH ordered MVP's killing covered up and the Tactigon removed from Armory. Soon after, Baron Von Blitzschlag set to work making his first clone of MVP, an exact duplicate sent back to Kentucky to take the place of the original. Von Blitzschlag quickly created three more clones, giving them copies of the "Iron Spider" armor that IRON MAN made for Spider-Man. As the SCARLET

SPIDERS, the three separated out MVP's name, calling themselves Michael, Van, and Patrick.

A CLONE TOO FAR

Delighted with the success of the Scarlet Spiders, Von Blitzschlag created another clone he called Ian, after the original MVP's middle name. In addition to MVP's memories, he gave the clone Armory's memories of the Tactigon and then attached the device to Ian. The feedback drove Ian insane. Realizing he was not the original MVP, he called himself KIA and then set out to kill everyone involved in MVP's death and cover-up. During this, he

injured many Initiative heroes and murdered the clone Van and several SHIELD agents.

To defeat him, the Initiative trainees found the original MVP clone, hoping to transfer his mind into a helmet and then copy it into MVP, but at the cost of wiping the first clone's mind. The first clone used the helmet to wipe KIA's mind instead.

Afterward, Michael and Patrick join the NEW WARRIORS. Michael dies while battling Ragnarok, an insane clone of THOR. Distraught, Patrick revealed his identity to the media, exposing the cover-up over MVP's death. **MF**



KIA was born bent on revenge for MVP's death.

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Michael Ian Van Patrick

OCCUPATION

Adventurer

BASE

Camp Hammond, Connecticut

HEIGHT

6 ft

WEIGHT

200 lbs

EYES

Blue

HAIR

Brown

FIRST APPEARANCE

Avengers: The Initiative #1
(April 2007)

MVP is a gifted athlete in top physical condition, with perfect DNA but without any superhuman powers.

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **Avengers: The Initiative #1** MVP is introduced and killed, all in a single issue.
- **Avengers: The Initiative #7** The Scarlet Spiders make their public debut and display their independence by helping Spider-Man.
- **Avengers: The Initiative #8-11** KIA is created and nearly destroys the Initiative.